

DEFEAT OF THE SPANISH ARMADA

Philip II of Spain's "Invincible Armada" sailed up the English Channel in order to ship an army across from the Spanish Netherlands to conquer England. In the end it was defeated in this battle, fought off Gravelines, and failed to rendezvous with the army. The Spanish fleet consisted of all kinds of ships, including galleons, armed merchantmen, and even Mediterranean galleasses, heavy oar-powered galleys, like the one shown in the center of the foreground.